NORTH BERWICK SELECT BOARD MINUTES
AUGUST 18, 2026

Present: Chairperson Michael Johnson Jr., Vice Chairperson Jonathan Hall, Selectperson Rebecca Reed

Also Present: Dwayne Morin, Mark Reed, Chief Stephen Peasley

1. PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

2. REVIEW AND APPROVE MINUTES OF AUGUST 4, 2026

Dwayne stated that he only made one change which was listed on page 6 of the packet. Selectperson Reed noted that the presence of Verna Sharpe was accidentally omitted and she request that be amended. Selectperson Reed motioned to approve the minutes as amended for August 4th, 2026. Selectperson Hall seconded the motion. VOTE: 3-0.

3. PUBLIC INPUT

There was no public input.

4. UNFINISHED BUSINESS:

A. REVALUATION: Update

Dwayne stated there is no update at this time.

B. ZONING ORDINANCE AMENDMENTS: Data Centers

The Planning Board voted at their last meeting on Thursday, August 13th to move this forward. The language on the ballot this November will be as follows:

"Question #2: Shall an ordinance entitled "Proposed Zoning Ordinance Amendment to Define and Prohibit Data Centers" be enacted?"

Selectperson Reed motioned to approve the ballot questions for the November ballot. Selectperson Hall seconded the motion. VOTE: 3-0.

C. COMP PLAN: Growth Area Amendment

The Planning Board voted at their last meeting on Thursday, August 13th to move this forward. The language on the ballot this November will be as follows:

"Question #1: Shall a Comprehensive Plan amendment entitled "Proposed Amendments to the North Berwick Comprehensive Plan" be enacted?"

Selectperson Reed motioned to approve the ballot questions for the November ballot. Selectperson Hall seconded the motion. VOTE: 3-0.

D. PUBLIC WORKS: Road Project Update

Dwayne stated that the Pheasant Hill paving project will begin within the next week or two. He also updated the Board on changes to the Cider Mill Pond Road project, including a heavy shim and revisions to the dirt area off Randall Road. Currently, the road curves in two directions, one of which leads to a private road. The new layout will create a 90-degree angle to make the traffic pattern clearer. Dwayne also stated that cars have ended up in the ditch during the winter, and he believes this change will help prevent that.

E. RESCUE: Sign Rescue Contract for 2027

Dwayne said that the contract was approved at the last meeting, however, he had forgotten to have the Board sign the contract. The resolution was signed; it is just the contract that needs signing tonight.

Reminders: Next Select Board's Meeting – September 1, 2026 – 6:30 P.M.-Room 212

5. NEW BUSINESS:

A. FIRE/RESCUE STATION: Update, Discuss Selection of CM at Risk

The committee, consisting of Dwayne, the Fire Chief, the Rescue Chief and the architects, completed interviews of both Jewett Construction and TPD Construction Company for the Fire/Rescue Station Construction Management at Risk. They were impressed with both firms and the scores were close, with Jewett scoring 96 out of 100 and TPD scoring 89 out of 100. The main deciding factor was total cost of fees associated with the project. Jewett Construction had a total fee estimate of $474,535.00 and TPD Construction had a total fee estimate of $752,213.00 making the difference of $277,678.00 in favor of Jewett Construction. Some of the

differences in fees included preconstruction fees, BABA (Buy American Build American) fees, and general conditions monthly fees. Dwayne also pointed out that Jewett stated they could complete the project in 6 to 8 months compared to TPD's timeline of 12 months.

Selectperson Hall motioned to allow the Town Manager to move forward with Jewett Construction for the Fire/Rescue Station construction bid. Selectperson Reed seconded the motion. VOTE: 3-0.

Dwayne also stated the possibility of demolishing the existing Rescue building and creating office spaces in a different location on the property. Both firms believe this option to be cost effective due to new codes, such as the energy code, making the current building non-compliant and expensive to bring up to code. Selectperson Hall stated if there was no real value in the current building, he doesn't see an issue with demolishing and rebuilding.

B. FY27 COMMITMENT: Commitment Review

Dwayne said that the FY Commitment documentation starts on page 42 of the Select Board packet. This years numbers for the Tax Rate Valuation are as follows:

Count	2,592
Real Estate Billable	1,117,513,600.00
Personal Property Billable	49,527,800.00
Homestead	29,875,000.00
Homestead x 0.76	22,705,000.00
BETE	312,326,500.00
Total Valuation	1,189,746,400.00

The allowable range for the tax rate cannot exceed a 5% overlay so he is recommending that the mil rate be set at 9.75/1,000. This means an average increase to single family homes around $256.00.

Selectperson Hall motioned for the 2026-2027 mil rate be set at 9.75/1,000. Selectperson Reed seconded the motion. VOTE: 3-0.

Dwayne stated that we anticipate tax bills going out around September 1st.

Chairperson Johnson, Jr. asked how the accounts payable were at the moment and wondered if the current inflation was affecting residents. Dwayne stated that the accounts payable remain healthy and we are around a 96% tax collection rate. There are currently 139 liens that will be filed, which is typical and on par compared to last fiscal year.

C. ZONING ORDINANCE AMENDMENTS: Draft of Housing Legislation Amendment LD 1829 and 2173

Dwayne said he had sent the language of changes to the Board in his email last week and wants to refrain from going into in-depth conversations until the entire Board is present. He did mention that there are significant changes coming to the Zoning Ordinance for the upcoming April Town Meeting. Some of these changes should be discussed with the collective input of the Planning Board as well.

He briefly touched upon some of the more massive changes, including increased changes in the number of dwelling units allowed on one lot, road frontage requirements decreasing, change of minimum lot sizes, and the Growth Ordinance. Dwayne wanted the Board to review some of the language the State has put out and be ready to discuss, at length, in upcoming meetings.

D. SURPLUS VEHICLES: Discuss Disposing of Excess Vehicles

Currently, the Town has 4 surplus vehicles that he is looking to sell. 3 of the vehicles are retired police cruisers and 1 is an ambulance. They all need batteries and only 1 vehicle, a 2015 Ford Explorer, would be considered in poor condition. The other vehicles are in decent condition. Dwayne discussed the challenges of selling vehicles these days including unreliable methods such as Facebook Marketplace. He wanted to present to the Board a new option that might be beneficial for all involved. Kyle Chandler, of Chandler's Automotive and Towing, came to Dwayne recently with an informal proposal to sell these vehicles by consignment on his new used car lot in Sanford. Dwayne wanted to take this to the Board to see if there was any interest in exploring this option. There is potential that this could maximize the amount these vehicles get sold for.

Selectperson Hall asked what Kyle Chandler might want for a percent or flat fee and Dwayne said that Kyle only talked about it briefly as a potential to bring to the Select Board. If the Board is interested, he could contact him to prepare a proposal to present to the Select Board. The Board thought this was a good idea and would like to have Kyle submit a proposal for consideration.

Chairperson Johnson, Jr. asked if we should junk the 2015 Ford Explorer to which Dwayne responded that there is potential that Kyle Chandler might purchase it for any parts or metal that he could use.

Dwayne also updated the Board regarding the Public Works one ton that was considered for surplus, however the Town is going to hold onto it for potential upcoming needs such as mowing and/or having an extra truck ready for the upcoming winter.

E. POLICE: Appoint New Officer- Jack Szczechowicz

Dwayne said that the previously approved police officer did not work out and Chief Peasley wanted to recommend Jack Szczechowicz for full-time patrol officer. Chief Peasley stated that Jack has already gone through his polygraph test, psych evaluation, and the physical assessment, all he passed. Jack is a lifelong North Berwick resident who has a bachelor's degree in business administration from the University of Maine Orono and has been a volunteer at the North Berwick Fire Department for the past two years.

Selectperson Reed inquired about his interest in police work and Chief Peasley stated that Jack said, "I want to help out in the town I grew up in". He also stated that the psychologist who completed his evaluation stated they believe he will be a long-term employee. Chief stated that he will be coming in as a green pin and will be attending the next Academy training in February 2027.

Selectperson Hall motioned to allow Chief Peasley to hire Jack Szczechowicz as a full-time patrol officer. Selectperson Reed seconded the motion. VOTE: 3-0.

Chief Peasley remained while Dwayne informed the Board of a growing issue at Bruce Abbott Park. People are using trailers to launch boats with more than 10 horsepower, which is not allowed. This has caused several concerns, including the spread of invasive plants in the pond. Dwayne had signs made stating that trailers are prohibited and violators will be towed; the signs will be posted at the park. Until now, police had been ticketing violators but now they will be enforcing towing now that signage will be at the park.

6. OTHER BUSINESS-

Selectperson Hall asked if there was any response from Pratt to which Dwayne responded we have not yet. He also asked about an update for the SRO at Noble High School which will be Kelly for the beginning of the year with the expectation of a return by the end of the school year for the previous SRO.

7. REVIEW AND APPROVE WARRANTS AND CORRESPONDENCE:

Warrant:	August 11, 2026	- $ 20,020.84
Warrant:	August 18, 2026	- $ 1,090,719.77

Selectperson Hall motioned to accept the warrant for August 11, 2026 in the amount of $20,020.84 and the warrant for August 18, 2026 in the amount of $1,090,719.77. Selectperson Reed seconded the motion. VOTE: 3-0.

8. ADJOURNMENT:

Selectperson Hall motioned to adjourn at 8:19 p.m. Selectperson Reed seconded the motion. VOTE: 3-0.

Respectively Submitted,

Bonnie Michaud, Stenographer
Original to Town Clerk

Chairperson: Michael Johnson, Jr.

Vice-Chairperson: Jonathan Hall

Selectperson: Wendy Cowan

Selectperson: Michael Johnson, Sr.

Selectperson: Rebecca Reed